ESTELLE EL-HAI *WORD COUNT: 750*
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MY EULOGY

It is my honor and the fact that I'm a kosher ham and have chutzpah, that I have been asked to present a eulogy for my beloved great, great grandmother, Estelle Marilyn Siegel El-Hai. This is a celebration of her life, and what a life it was..... one hundred and twenty years short.

Her years were filled with laughter and sunshine. One of her favorite mottos hung on her kitchen wall. It reads, "One Hundred Years From Now...it will not matter what my bank account was, the sort of home I lived in, or the kind of car I drove. But the world may be different because I was important in the life of a child."

Most of her framed sentiment was true, but a good deal of it can be argued. Bubby, as all of her grandchildren called her, was important in every child's life in her family. She not only witnessed and took part in the births of her children and grandchildren, but did her utmost in being part of their lives and future plans. She disciplined herself, successfully for the most part, not to interfere but to encourage and guide when asked. Bubby fiercely wanted her family to share the optimistic enthusiasm she felt for life and in nature's gifts.

So which part of her motto was not one hundred per cent accurate you ask?

Let's start with the bank account. I told you that I had chutzpah! Was that important? You betcha! Each summer, even before great-great grandpa Sam died, she paid for a wonderful family reunion house, in an especially designated area of the United States. After awhile, it grew to be three houses. The entire El-Hai clan would meet there , from assorted areas, assuring that the family bonds would always be intact and strong. We would catch up on all the news, jobs, babies, and exciting opportunities that some were offered in distant parts of the world. Which new Jack El-Hai book was on the best seller list again, a clarification of that blue-green algae research that finally won Uncle Jeff the Nobel Prize, the breakthrough in asthma that Aunt Laurisa was recognized for, and the prestigious award presented by King Charles to Aunt Joline for her beautiful work in stained glass, now displayed in Buckingham Palace and the Chateau de Versailles Museum.

Wherever and whenever these awards were presented, Bubby was there. But I am straying from my subject about her bank account. The fact is, she made many important events possible because she was happy and able to pay for it.

The kind of house she lived in is memorable too. Many of her friends in Sun City had professional designers fashion and decorate their homes. Bubby wanted it to be "her" home, not with some home arrangers ideas. She said that art was a bouquet of flowers; like a rainbow, and everything did not need to match. Beauty blends with nature.

Cobalt blue was everywhere in Bubby's home. It made her happy to gaze at brilliant colors, even though Feng-shui teachers did not always agree with her selections. Her family room boasted of her brood with many photos displayed on the walls. Even though the frames differed in size and texture, they were tastefully placed. Her home looked and felt "lived-in" and "loved-in", and expressed beauty and fun.

What about the car mentioned in that motto? Did it have importance? I believe it did, Bubby earned it in her nutrition business, and when it got a little old, she gave it to one of her great grand kids who were responsible and had recently received a driver's license. Then she bought a purple Porche (good old bank account again) and drove it until a few years ago. Later, she hired a good looking young driver who took her to her favorite spots, mostly to thrift stores and garage sales.

My Bubby was a good old girl. She was not afraid to make fun of herself and she dearly loved people. She would always spot the shy ones and converse with them. Her goal was to make them laugh and to like themselves a little more.

I'm told that I take after my great-great grandma. My name is Stella El-Hai, which translates to Princess Starlight, the living goddess. Here's looking at you Bubby. Don't mess things up too much up there.....only just a little. We love you !

*** *Finis* ***